

Upgrade:

If mobile entertainment is to be widely used in Europe, consumers must be prepared to upgrade their handsets. In markets with high penetration rates such as Italy, the UK and Germany, there is evidence that upgrading is occurring but not necessarily as regularly as operators and manufacturers would hope.

Phones and PDAs:

European member states vary in the type and number of 'Web-enabled mobile devices'. In Europe mobiles are the most likely devices for mobile entertainment applications. No country (Bulgaria excluded) is expected to have more than 20 per cent of its Web-enabled devices in PDA, laptop or console form.

Age:

There is a pervasive assumption that it will be teenagers that drive the mobile entertainment market. This results in a concentration on young people within research into mobile entertainment.

73 per cent of children aged 10-17 surveyed by Accenture used mobile phones, but while the majority thought that gaming was one of the key functions of the phone, 91 per cent described current games as 'poor' or 'average'.

Age is a significant factor in SMS usage although it is not clear whether this will translate into MMS usage. It is predicted that by 2006, 15-19 year olds will constitute the bulk of MMS in the larger markets.

Age is also thought to be a significant factor in mobile gaming demographics. A recent IN-FUSIO/Orange market survey of 600 existing Orange France customers with ExEn-enabled handsets revealed that 78 per cent of players were less than 25 years of age, and 92 per cent under 34 years.